PAWPOLLER · GETTING STARTED GUIDE

DeviantArt

Track views/faves/comments on a DeviantArt gallery, and post to it.

Analytics + Posting | Medium Setup

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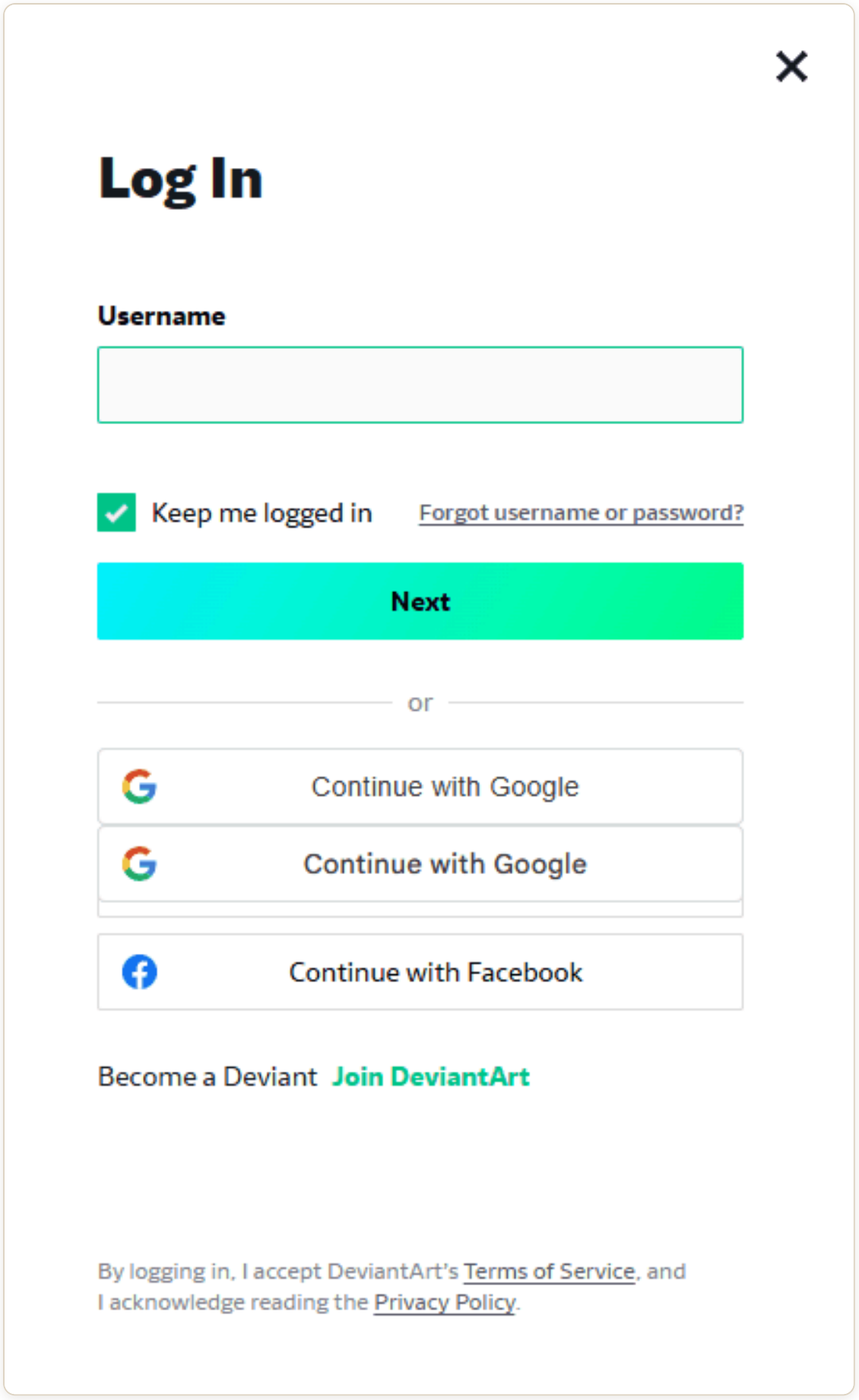
WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- A DeviantArt account
- A DeviantArt "app" you register yourself — free, about two minutes

STEP BY STEP

1 **Sign in to DeviantArt**

Sign in at deviantart.com in a desktop browser — the username comes first, then **Next** asks for the password. Everything below happens while signed in as the account you want tracked. deviantart.com ↗



DeviantArt's Log In dialog: the Username step with Next

2 **Register a DeviantArt app**

Open **Applications** (under Developers) and press **Register Application**. Any name will do — "PawPoller" is fine. Set **Client type** to **Confidential**, accept the terms, and save. DeviantArt Applications ↗

3 **Copy the two codes it gives you**

The app's page shows a `client_id` (a short number) and a `client_secret` (a long string). You will paste both into PawPoller. Treat the secret like a password.

4 **Connect in PawPoller**

In **Settings** → **DeviantArt**, paste the `client_id`, the `client_secret` and the DeviantArt **username to track**, then press **Connect**. Stats arrive on the next check.

5 **Only if you want to post: allow it**

Press **Authorise posting** and approve on DeviantArt. ⚠ DeviantArt approves **whichever account that browser is signed in to** — not the one you pressed the button for. With more than one account, open a private window, sign in as the right one, and press it there.

6 **Add the return address to your app**

DeviantArt only comes back to an address listed on your app, and it is the **address you opened PawPoller at** plus `/api/da/auth/callback`. Pressing **Authorise posting** prints the exact line to copy. Paste it into **Applications** → **Edit** → **OAuth2 Redirect URI Whitelist**, save there, then press the button again. Typical ones: `http://127.0.0.1:8420/api/da/auth/callback` for the desktop app, `https://yourmachine.your-tailnet.ts.net/api/da/auth/callback` over Tailscale, `https://pawpoller.yourdomain.com/api/da/auth/callback` on your own web address. Open PawPoller two ways and you need both lines — the list takes as many as you like. **Moved to a hosted seat or a new address?** Add the new line too (a seat's is `https://paw-yourseat.pawpoller.com/api/da/auth/callback`), then press Authorise posting again.

7 **Descriptions only: open DeviantArt as the posting account**

You only need the next steps if you want PawPoller to **change descriptions** on DeviantArt. Tracking and posting work without them. In a desktop browser, open deviantart.com signed in as the **same account PawPoller posts as**. You should see your avatar in the top corner. deviantart.com ↗

8 **Descriptions only: open the developer tools**

Press **F12** on the keyboard (on a Mac: **Cmd + Option + I**). A panel opens beside or under the page.

9 **Descriptions only: go to Network and refresh**

In that panel, click the **Network** tab, then refresh the page (**F5**). A list of requests fills up.

10 **Descriptions only: click the first request**

Click the first line in the list, the one named `www.deviantart.com`. Details for it open on the side.

11 Descriptions only: copy the Cookie value

In those details, scroll to **Request Headers** and find the line called **Cookie**. Select the **whole** value after it (it is very long, with many `name=value;` parts) and copy it. Copy all of it, not one part.

12 Descriptions only: paste it into PawPoller

In PawPoller, open your DeviantArt account's **Credentials**, paste the value into `da_cookie`, and press **Save**. Treat it like a password: anyone holding it is signed in as you.

13 Descriptions only: test it

Press the account's **Test** button. A green result means descriptions will sync. The cookie stops working when you sign out of DeviantArt in that browser, or after a few weeks. PawPoller then shows **DA-COOKIE-EXPIRED**: repeat these steps and paste the new value over the old one.

WHERE IT GOES IN PAWPOLLER

Settings → DeviantArt → client_id + client_secret + username to track

KEEPING IT ALIVE

Posting stops working (tracking keeps going). Press Authorise posting again. The app's own codes do not expire.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Tracking and posting use DeviantArt's official API, with no browser cookie. **Changing a description** is the one exception: DeviantArt only lets a signed-in browser do it, which is what the **Descriptions only** steps above set up.
- **DA-COOKIE-MISSING**: no `da_cookie` is saved, so a sync changed the title, tags and rating but not the description. Follow the Descriptions only steps, then sync again.
- **DA-COOKIE-EXPIRED**: the saved `da_cookie` no longer signs you in (you signed out, or it aged out after a few weeks). Copy a fresh one the same way and paste it over the old one.
- Tracking needs only the app. Posting as you needs the extra approval, which is the only way DeviantArt will issue that permission.
- Journals (Posts → **New journal**) need one more permission. If DeviantArt says so, press **Authorise posting** again: the new approval includes it.
- On a server, DA is polled through the Cloudflare proxy — data-centre addresses are blocked.